

Doctors of the Church

A Doctor of the Church expands the knowledge of the faith with their research and study.

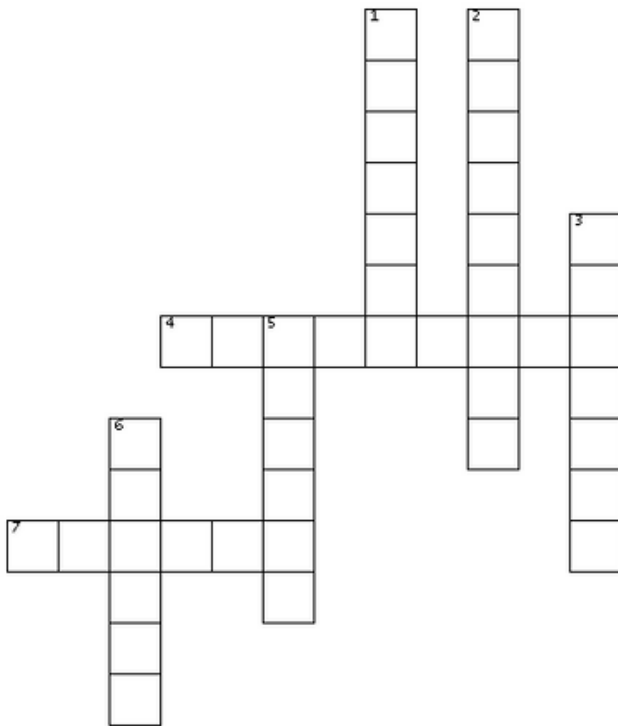


"The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord, and knowledge of the Holy One is understanding."
- Proverbs 9:10



Crossword Puzzle

Use the clues to fill in the words above. Words can go across or down.
Letters are shared when the words intersect.



ACROSS

- 4. Mystic and Third Order Dominican often depicted with a crown of thorns on her head.
- 7. Carmelite nun who wrote *Interior Castles* and *The Way of Perfection*.

DOWN

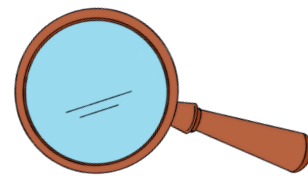
- 1. Known as the "Little Flower".
- 2. Wrote *City of God* and *Confessions*.
- 3. A "Great" pope known for his humility and love of poverty.
- 5. Known as the Angelic Doctor
- 6. Translated the Old and New Testaments into Latin.



Did You Know?

In the Middle Ages, the first 4 saints declared Doctors of the Church were chosen. They were: "St. Ambrose, 4th century bishop of Milan; St. Augustine, 5th century bishop of Hippo; St. Gregory the Great, who was pope at the start of the 7th century; and St. Jerome, the 5th century biblical scholar and translator." (Doctors of the Church?, 2015)

Reflection Questions



Pause to reflect on the wisdom of the saints.

Doctors of the Church typically share wisdom in one of these areas: scholarship, apologetics (or the dispelling of heresy), mysticism, spirituality, and theology. Which of these areas do you gravitate towards? Which areas do you believe you may be gifted in?

Consider your answers from the previous question. What are some ways you can grow in knowledge in the areas you are gifted in and gravitate toward?

Response of Supplication

Use your reflections to guide a prayer to the Lord.

Ask the Holy Spirit to illuminate your heart, mind, and will to understand how you can grow in wisdom and knowledge. Is He calling you to read Scripture on your own, read a book written by a saint, attend a retreat, or watch a Catholic YouTube on a topic you like?

Guided Imaginative Prayer

Follow the prompt to enter into imaginative prayer.

Let's imagine a real life scene from Doctor of the Church, St. Therese of Lisieux to grow in wisdom with her. Imagine you are kneeling beside St. Therese in a chapel and her community is praying the rosary together. In the row behind you, a sister continually lets the crucifix on her rosary beads knock loudly against the pew. She says the Hail Mary out of sync with the rest of the group and you are starting to get very annoyed. St. Therese is closing her eyes very hard and you see a few beads of sweat on her forehead. She is trying so hard to not be distracted. She takes a deep, but quiet breath. You follow her lead and calm your spirit, offering this little annoyance up to the Lord and praying with great love.



REFERENCES:

Answers, Catholic. 2021. "Doctors of the Church." Catholic Answers. October 18, 2021.
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